In team meeting after team meeting, in huddle after huddle, we listened, and we believed the mantras. As a group and as individuals, we craved this title. After all the pain, this was our moment, surely.

Shahid Afridi had long been recognised as one of the most gifted players in the game, capable of producing brilliance on one day and something less than brilliance the next. On the slow turner at Nottingham, we had desperately wanted it to be our day; it turned out to be Afridi's day.

He batted at No. 3, drilled his second ball over mid-on for four, scored 51 runs from 34 balls and helped Pakistan reach 149 for four from 20 overs. Our fielding had been excellent throughout the tournament but, on this big day, it had inexplicably frayed at the edges. Never mind, we told ourselves, we can get these runs. Graeme and Jacques opened and took us to 39 after five overs. We needed only to hold our nerve and we would get there, surely.

Graeme was out in the sixth over. Afridi prepared to bowl the seventh. His slider dismissed Herschelle Gibbs, and I joined Jacques at the crease. Saeed Ajmal was bowling well, and conceded only three runs from the eighth over. Afridi prepared to bowl the ninth. Jacques took a single from the first ball. I pushed at a leg break, gave a chance and was dropped by the wicketkeeper. Stay calm. Maybe this would be our day. Afridi ran in again. I aimed to cut. It was the slider. I was bowled.

Suddenly, at 50 for three, we were in trouble. Jacques and JP Duminy steadied the innings, consolidated and kept us in contention until we needed 45 runs from the last four; then the target was 39 from the last three. I could barely bear to watch from the dug-out.

Albie Morkel went out to bat when Jacques was caught at long-on, and we required 29 from the last two overs. It was tough. One big over would make the difference, taking us to the final where we wanted to be, where we had imagined we would be; but the one big over never came.

The 19th over was going to be crucial and Umar Gul, the Pakistani fast bowler, delivered a series of impeccable yorkers. We only scored six runs.